

Chronic Lymphocytic Leukemia (CLL) Testing and Treatment Toolkit

INTRODUCTION

Purpose. This document includes tools and resources to support biomarker testing and treatment in CLL patients. The tools can be used by nurse navigators, providers or other non-provider staff to track and document biomarker testing and CLL treatments.

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BIOMARKER TESTING CHECKLIST

	Task:	Notes:
☐	- Discuss the purpose and benefits of biomarker testing with patient - Obtain informed consent	Refer to Nurse Navigator Toolkit for a biomarker patient discussion guide
☐	Sample Collection and Preparation: - Collect appropriate blood and/or tissue samples - Ensure proper handling and preservation per lab's requirements	
☐	Review any additional lab specimen requirements	
☐	Choose appropriate biomarker tests/panels: ☐ TP53 ☐ del(11q) ☐ del(13q) ☐ del(17p) ☐ IGHV/IGVH ☐ CpG-stimulated karyotype ☐ Other: _____ ☐ Other: _____ ☐ Other: _____	
☐	Internal Lab: Send to lab External Lab: Prepare samples for shipping and ship samples to lab	Ensure adherence to documentation requirements, which may include: - Patient information - Clinical history - Testing preferences
☐	External Lab: Document the external lab's contact information and sample send out date in the EHR	Consider providing the patient with the external lab's contact information.

	Task:	Notes:
☐	Confirm Receipt By the Lab: • Contact lab if receipt has not been confirmed by _____ to prevent delays. (insert date) • Contact lab if results have not been received by _____ to prevent delays. (insert date) • Document date of communication with lab and their response in the patient's EHR.	
☐	Receive and upload biomarker data analysis report into the EHR, under the _____ tab. (insert tab name)	Depending on the vendor, some results may require portal access to view and download. Best practice is to have a standardized documentation location. See Nurse Navigator Toolkit for additional information.
☐	Communicate results to ordering physician and involve multidisciplinary team (tumor board), as needed.	Consider bookmarking results in the EHR for easy identification by the provider.

Access the Biomarker Testing Checklist dotphrase template [here](#) and review the Dotphrase Implementation Tool on page 5.

CLL TESTING AND TREATMENT TRACKER

Background. The CLL Testing and Treatment Tracker is a dotphrase template that summarizes key and actionable information surrounding the patient’s cancer journey. The document contains relevant information that is often spread across tens or even hundreds of clinical notes or documents in EHR. This document can improve patient care by:

1

Streamlining the prior authorization process

This single document can be attached to prior authorization requests to summarize and support approval criteria, reducing additional information requests, peer-to-peer calls and denials (Refer to [Prior Authorization Toolkit](#) for more information).

2

Reducing EHR burden on staff/providers

The document makes key patient information easily accessible when making clinical decisions, reducing the need to search in multiple tabs of the EHR to find actionable information like biomarker results.

3

Streamlining referrals

The document can be sent to other providers when referring a patient, providing a “snapshot” of the relevant patient information.

4

Optimizing multidisciplinary communication

Similar to referrals, the “snapshot” information can be useful for facilitating multidisciplinary communication, both inside and outside of the tumor board environment.

Dotphrase functionality integrates the template seamlessly into the EHR, is easily customizable and streamlines documentation workflows. In many EHRs the template can also auto populate certain data like patient demographics and lab or imaging results (restrictions may apply, see below*).

To access the CLL Testing and Treatment Tracker, click [here](#).

DOTPHRASE IMPLEMENTATION GUIDE

IF USING EPIC SMARTPHRASES:

Within Epic:

- Go to personalize → my SmartPhrases → new
- Under settings enter a SmartPhrase name and description
- Paste the SmartPhrase template into the SmartPhrase field
- The template can be customized using SmartTexts, SmartLists and wildcards

The templates are pre-populated with wildcards for the data/information fields (except for the demographic section).

Wildcards are used to designate free text fields, and are indicated in the template with three asterisks (***). You can quickly navigate to the free text areas by pressing the F2 key.

If you wish to replace free text fields with dropdown lists, you can use SmartLists.

SmartLists are customizable dropdowns that can be auto-populated into your note. You can create SmartLists by using the SmartList interface and entering your dropdown options. Once a SmartList is embedded in a SmartPhrase, it will allow you to select from the pre-defined dropdown options in the designated fields.

If you wish to automatically populate information from the patient's record into the template, you can use SmartTexts.*

SmartTexts will pull information or data from other parts of the patient record and auto-populate them into your note. The template is prepopulated with SmartText in the demographic sections. Examples of SmartText data could be the patient's name, MRN, recent labs or imaging results. These sections can be designated by placing the @ symbol before and after the approved SmartText. So, to auto-populate the patient's name into the template, you can use @Name@, for example. Approved SmartTexts can vary from organization to organization; your IT department should be able to provide a list of approved SmartTexts, and may be able to build out custom SmartText options.

IF USING NON-EPIC EHR DOTPHRASES:

The templates can still be utilized, but advanced functionality (lists, wildcards, etc) may differ. Consult with your IT department to determine what functionality is available at your health system.

* In addition to organization-specific SmartTexts, biomarker data integration may also be limited by the lack of structured data within the EHR. For additional information and potential solutions, refer to the [Biomarker Data Optimization Case Study](#).

References:

1. American College of Emergency Physicians. Things You Can Do on Your Own - Epic. Accessed December, 7, 2023. [https://www.acep.org/administration/quality/health-information-technology/epic-articles/things-you-can-do-on-your-own-epic#:~:text=Also%20known%20as%20%E2%80%9Cdot%20phrases,a%20single%20sentence%20\(eg%3A%20](https://www.acep.org/administration/quality/health-information-technology/epic-articles/things-you-can-do-on-your-own-epic#:~:text=Also%20known%20as%20%E2%80%9Cdot%20phrases,a%20single%20sentence%20(eg%3A%20)
2. Trinity Health. Using SmartTools. Accessed December, 7, 2023. https://www.sjmed.com/for-physicians/easset_upload_file18213_500417_e.pdf